

Cybersecurity Analyst — Minimum Requirements to Apply

Complete everything marked **MUST HAVE** before sending first application | Target: ₹4.5–7 LPA

CERTIFICATIONS — Minimum to Apply

	Certification	Provider	Must Have / Nice to Have	Where to Get
☐	ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)	ISC2	MUST HAVE	isc2.org/certifications/cc — free exam
☐	Google Cybersecurity Certificate	Google/Coursera	MUST HAVE	Coursera financial aid — free
☐	IBM Security Analyst Fundamentals	IBM SkillsBuild	MUST HAVE	skillsbuild.org — free badge
☐	Cybersecurity Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — free
☐	Introduction to Cybersecurity	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — free
☐	IBM Cybersecurity Fundamentals	IBM SkillsBuild	Strong to Have	skillsbuild.org — free
☐	Fortinet NSE 1 + NSE 2	Fortinet	Strong to Have	training.fortinet.com — free
☐	Junior Cybersecurity Analyst	Cisco NetAcad	Strong to Have	netacad.com — free
☐	Linux Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	Nice to Have	netacad.com — free

TRYHACKME ROOMS — Minimum to Apply

	Room Name	Free/Premium	Must Have / Nice to Have	Why It Matters
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☐	Pre-Security Path	FREE	MUST HAVE	Non-negotiable foundation for all security work
☐	Defensive Security Intro	FREE	MUST HAVE	Establishes defender mindset for analyst role
☐	Intro to SIEM	FREE	MUST HAVE	SIEM is core tool for cybersecurity analysts
☐	MITRE ATT&CK	FREE	MUST HAVE	Framework every cybersecurity analyst uses daily
☐	Vulnerability Management	FREE	MUST HAVE	CVE triage and patching is core analyst work
☐	Threat Intelligence Tools	FREE	MUST HAVE	CTI tools separate good analysts from average ones
☐	Cyber Kill Chain	FREE	MUST HAVE	Attack lifecycle knowledge is interview standard
☐	Phishing Analysis Fundamentals	FREE	MUST HAVE	Most common analyst investigation task
☐	Pyramid of Pain	FREE	Strong to Have	IOC framework — shows depth of knowledge
☐	Malware Analysis Intro	FREE	Strong to Have	Basic malware knowledge expected at analyst level
☐	Nessus Basics	FREE	Strong to Have	Nessus is most used vulnerability scanner in India
☐	Diamond Model	FREE	Nice to Have	Threat analysis framework — interview differentiator

☐	OpenCTI	FREE	Nice to Have	CTI platform hands-on — advanced but impressive
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5 GOATED PROJECTS — Pick 2 to Build Before Applying

	Project Name	What You Build	Tools / Stack	Why Recruiters Love It
☐	Vulnerability Assessment Report	Run OpenVAS or Nessus Free on a vulnerable VM (Metasploitable), document all findings, rate by CVSS score, write professional remediation report	OpenVAS (free), Metasploitable VM, VirtualBox, Word/PDF	<i>Vulnerability assessment is the most requested skill for cybersecurity analyst roles. A real report on GitHub = instant proof of skill.</i>
☐	Malware Sandbox Analysis Report	Take 3 real malware samples from MalwareBazaar (free), analyse each in Any.run sandbox, extract IOCs, write a professional threat report for each	Any.run (free tier), MalwareBazaar, VirusTotal, PDF report	<i>Malware analysis experience is rare at fresher level. Three documented reports with IOCs and professional writeups is exceptional.</i>
☐	Log Analysis + Anomaly Detector	Build a Python script that analyses sample log files, detects anomalies (failed logins, unusual hours, suspicious IPs), generates alert report	Python, Pandas, Matplotlib, sample log datasets from Kaggle	<i>Your Big Data background makes this natural. Bridges your existing ML skills to security — very compelling for interview narrative.</i>
☐	CTI Threat Intelligence Report	Research a real active threat actor (e.g. APT28, Lazarus Group), write a professional 5-page threat intelligence report using MITRE ATT&CK, IOCs, TTPs	MITRE ATT&CK website, OSINT tools, VirusTotal, PDF/Word	<i>Professional threat reports demonstrate analytical writing — a skill most freshers lack entirely. Instantly differentiates your application.</i>
☐	Security Audit Checklist Tool	Build a Python tool that runs through a security checklist (CIS Controls top 20), asks yes/no questions, calculates a risk score, outputs a PDF audit report	Python, ReportLab (PDF generation), CIS Controls framework	<i>GRC awareness + automation + reporting in one project. Relevant to analyst, GRC, and even cloud security roles — triple value.</i>